



BLOCK & BULL

— THE FREE STARTER GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

Crypto, from the first click.

Open an account. Lock it down. Buy your first coin. Understand what staking actually pays you and where that yield comes from. No jargon, no signals, no promises about what you will make.

- ✓ Opening an account
- ✓ Security on day one
- ✓ Funding and fees
- ✓ Your first buy
- ✓ Staking and Earn
- ✓ India tax snapshot

Written by the Block and Bull desk · blocknbull.xyz

Educational content only. Not financial advice. Crypto is high risk and you can lose everything you put in. 18+

What this guide is, and what it is not.

WHAT IT IS

- ✓ A plain walkthrough of the mechanics
- ✓ Written for somebody who has never opened an exchange account
- ✓ Honest about fees, risk and what you cannot control
- ✓ Something to read once and act on

WHAT IT IS NOT

- ✗ Advice on what to buy, or when
- ✗ A prediction about any price
- ✗ A promise that you will make money
- ✗ A substitute for reading the exchange terms yourself

Nothing here is for sale.

This edition carries no links, no sign-up buttons and no exchange names attached to an offer. It was written to teach the mechanics, and that is the whole job it is doing.

Where an exchange is mentioned it is as an example of how the machinery works, never as a recommendation to use one. Choosing a platform is your decision and chapter 02 gives you the criteria to make it with.

THE RISK, STATED ONCE AND MEANT

Crypto prices move violently and can go to zero. Nothing here is a recommendation to buy, sell or hold anything. Only ever commit money you can afford to lose entirely, and if you are unsure, speak to a qualified professional before you act.

Nine short chapters.

01

What an exchange actually is

Custody, order books, and who is holding your coins

02

Open your account in four steps

Choosing a platform, signing up, and passing verification

03

Lock it down on day one

The five minutes that stop most account losses

04

Put money in

Routes, rails and what each one costs you

05

Your first buy

Market order against limit order, in plain terms

06

What fees really cost

The number nobody shows you, worked through

07

Staking and Earn, explained

Where the yield comes from and what you give up

08

What goes wrong

The four ways beginners lose money

09

The India position

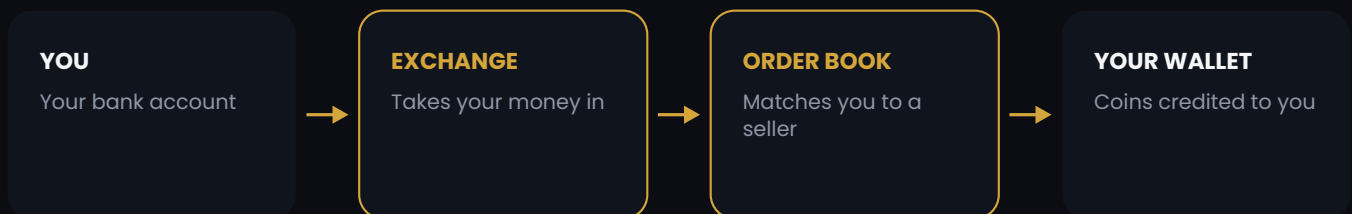
Tax, TDS and which exchanges are reachable

READ IT IN THIS ORDER

Chapters 01 to 03 before you put any money in, because they are the ones that protect you. 04 to 06 on the day you fund the account. 07 to 09 whenever you are ready, and 09 first if you are filing taxes in India this year.

What an exchange actually is.

An exchange is a marketplace plus a bank vault wearing one uniform. The marketplace matches your buy order against somebody else's sell order. The vault holds the coins afterwards. Understanding that these are two different jobs is most of what separates a confident beginner from a nervous one.



THE PART THAT MATTERS

While your coins sit on the exchange, the exchange holds the keys, not you. That is fine for trading and convenient for beginners. It is also why people move long-term holdings to their own wallet. Custody is a choice you are making whether you think about it or not.

The three words you will meet immediately

Spot Buying the actual coin at the current price. You own it. Simplest thing on the platform.

Futures A contract that tracks the price, usually with borrowed size attached. Losses grow as fast as gains. Not a beginner product.

Earn Parking coins you already own so the platform pays you a yield. Chapter 07 takes this apart properly.

Open your account in four steps.

Fifteen minutes end to end, most of it waiting on verification. Do it on a laptop if you can. Typing an email address wrong on a phone is the most common way this goes sideways.

1

Go to the exchange directly

Type the address in yourself. Never reach an exchange from a message, an advert or a search result you did not check.

2

Confirm your email

Check spam. Set a password you have never used anywhere else, and let your password manager generate it.

3

Pass verification

Photo ID and a selfie. Usually minutes, sometimes a day. You cannot deposit or withdraw properly until this clears.

4

Turn on the security settings

Do not skip to buying. Chapter 03 is five minutes and it is the difference between an account you keep and one you lose.

HOW TO JUDGE A PLATFORM

Four questions worth answering before you register anywhere. Is it licensed or registered to operate where you live. Does it publish its fee schedule in full. Can you withdraw to your own wallet without a special request. What does its withdrawal process look like when something goes wrong. A platform that makes any of those hard to find has told you something.

Lock it down on day one.

Almost nobody loses an account to a clever hack. They lose it to a reused password, an SMS code intercepted, or a message from somebody pretending to be support. These five settings close all three doors and they take about five minutes.

✓ **App-based 2FA, not SMS**

Use Google Authenticator or Authy. A phone number can be ported away from you by someone who social-engineers your telecom provider. An app on your device cannot.

✓ **Write down the backup codes**

On paper. Put them where you keep your passport. If you lose your phone with no backup codes, you lose the account.

✓ **Set an anti-phishing code**

A short phrase the exchange puts in every genuine email to you. Any mail without it is fake. This single setting kills the most common scam outright.

✓ **Whitelist your withdrawal address**

Funds can then only leave to an address you approved in advance, usually with a delay on changes. It turns a total loss into a blocked attempt.

✓ **Decide about the API tab, then leave it alone**

API keys let software trade for you. You almost certainly do not need one. Never give an API key with withdrawal rights to anybody, for any reason.

NOBODY LEGITIMATE WILL EVER ASK FOR THESE

Your password. Your 2FA code. Your seed phrase. An API key. A deposit sent to a personal wallet to "verify" or "activate" anything. Not the exchange, not us, not an admin in any group. Every single person who asks is running a scam.

Put money in.

Three routes onto an exchange, and they are not equally priced. The one the app pushes hardest is usually the most expensive.

Bank transfer or UPI

Cheapest

Slowest to set up, near free to use. Local rails vary by country. This is how most people should fund an account they intend to keep.

Card purchase

Most expensive

Instant and convenient, and you pay for both. Card routes commonly cost several percent once the spread is counted. Fine for a first small test, poor as a habit.

Peer to peer

Cheap, more care needed

You buy directly from another user with the exchange holding the coins in escrow. Low fees, but only ever release escrow after the money is actually in your bank.

One habit worth building now

Send a small test amount first, every time you use a new route or a new address. Ten dollars arriving safely tells you the path works. Ten thousand arriving nowhere tells you it did not, far too late.

Your first buy.

Two order types cover almost everything a beginner needs. The difference between them is simply whether you care more about certainty of price or certainty of filling.

MARKET ORDER

Buy now, at whatever the price is

Fills immediately. You take the price the market offers, which on a thin coin can be worse than the number you saw. Usually charged the higher taker fee.

USE WHEN

Getting in matters more than the last 0.1%

LIMIT ORDER

Buy only at the price you name

You set the price and wait. It may never fill. Usually charged the lower maker fee, because you added an order to the book rather than taking one off it.

USE WHEN

The price matters more than the wait

What the screen is telling you

The order book

Buyers stacked on one side, sellers on the other. The gap between the best of each is the spread, and the spread is a cost you pay without seeing a fee line.

The candle

One candle is one slice of time. Body shows where it opened and closed, wicks show how far it stretched. That is the whole idea.

The pair

BTC/USDT means you are pricing bitcoin in a dollar-pegged token. You are always trading one thing against another, never against nothing.

What fees really cost.

A 0.055% fee sounds like nothing. It is nothing, once. The number that matters is what it adds up to across a year of ordinary activity, and almost nobody works it out before they start.

WORKED THROUGH, ON ROUND NUMBERS

You trade	\$10,000 of volume in a month
Taker fee at 0.055%	\$5.50 charged by the exchange
Maker fee at 0.020%	\$2.00 for the same volume
Over twelve months, taker	\$66.00 gone in fees
Trade ten times that volume	\$660 in fees a year

Illustrative arithmetic on a standard taker fee. Your actual tier, fees and eligible volume are set by the exchange.

The fee nobody itemises

The spread is the second cost and it never appears on a statement. If the best buy sits at 100 and the best sell at 100.4, you have paid 0.4 before the fee line is even calculated. On a thinly traded coin that gap can be larger than every fee you will pay that month.

This is why limit orders matter and why volume matters. You are not just choosing a price, you are choosing how much of the spread you hand over.

Staking and Earn, explained properly.

You hold coins doing nothing. A platform offers to pay you a yield on them. The only question worth asking is the one most people skip: who is paying that yield, and what did you give up to receive it?

Where the money actually comes from

● Real staking

The blockchain itself pays you for helping secure it. The yield is newly issued coins. This is genuine and it is usually the lowest number on the page.

● Lending

The platform lends your coins to traders who want borrowed size, and passes you part of the interest. Higher yield, and it rests on those borrowers being good for it.

● Promotional

The platform pays out of its marketing budget to attract deposits. Often the biggest headline number, usually capped, time-limited, and gone later.

Flexible against locked

FLEXIBLE

Withdraw whenever you want. Lower rate. The rate can also be changed by the platform while your money sits there.

LOCKED

Higher rate, and your coins are stuck for the term. If the price falls 40% in week two, you watch. That is the trade you made.

THE SENTENCE TO REMEMBER

A yield paid in a coin that falls 30% is not a gain. Earn products pay you in the asset, so the price risk stays entirely yours. Percentages advertised as APY assume compounding that may not happen.

What goes wrong.

Four failures account for most of the money beginners lose. None of them are exotic and all of them are avoidable.

01**Borrowed size**

Futures with borrowed size can close your position entirely on a move that would have been survivable in spot. The first year is for spot. There is no rush.

02**The scam that looks like help**

A message offering to recover your funds, a support account that found you first, a group admin with a special opportunity. Real support never messages you first.

03**Buying the loudest thing**

The coin all over your feed is the one somebody is trying to sell you. Attention is manufactured cheaply and it is usually manufactured by holders.

04**Forgetting the tax**

Gains get taxed whether or not you kept records. Export your trade history every quarter. Reconstructing a year of it later is miserable and expensive.

The one rule under all four

Decide what you are willing to lose before you are in the position, not while you are watching it fall. Every expensive decision in this market gets made after the money is already moving.

The India position.

If you are in India this chapter is the one that costs you money if you skip it. Current as of September 2026, and worth confirming yourself because the rules here move.

30%

Flat tax on gains

Section 115BBH taxes profit on transferring a virtual digital asset at 30%, plus surcharge and a 4% cess. That works out near 31.2% effective. Holding period makes no difference.

1%

TDS at source

Section 194S withholds 1% on the transfer itself. Thresholds are ₹50,000 for specified persons and ₹10,000 otherwise. On a foreign exchange or a peer-to-peer trade the duty to deduct sits with the buyer.

0

Losses you can offset

A loss on one token cannot be set against a gain on another, cannot go against other income, and cannot be carried forward. Each gain is taxed on its own.

Two practical consequences

Report through Schedule VDA when you file, on ITR-2 or ITR-3 depending on whether you are reporting capital gains or business income. Keep every trade export, because the 1% TDS already deducted is only useful to you if you can evidence it.

On reachability: several international platforms cannot legally serve Indian users, and at least one was blocked under an FIU-IND direction in September 2026. Availability changes often, so confirm it on the platform's own site before you register rather than after.

This is a summary of published rules, not tax advice, and it is not a substitute for a chartered accountant who knows your situation. Verify the current position before you file.

Do the first one today.

Reading this guide changes nothing on its own. Opening the account, turning on the security settings and putting in an amount you would not miss is the whole beginning. Everything else builds on top of that.

STEP ONE

Open the account.

Pick the platform yourself, on the criteria in chapter 02. Type the address in rather than following a link from anywhere, confirm it is allowed to operate where you live, and turn on every setting in chapter 03 before you fund it.

STEP TWO

Write the plan down.

Before the first order, put four things on paper. What you are buying and why. The price that tells you the idea was wrong. What you are prepared to lose on it. What would make you sell if it goes right. A decision made in advance is the only kind you can hold to while the number is moving, and re-reading it later is how you find out what you actually got wrong.

The words, in one place.

APR / APY	A rate before compounding, and after it. APY assumes you keep reinvesting, which may not be what happens.
Custody	Who holds the keys. On an exchange, the exchange does.
KYC	Identity verification. Required before you can move real money.
Maker / taker	You added an order to the book, or you took one off it. Takers pay more.
Seed phrase	The twelve or twenty-four words that restore a private wallet. Anyone holding them owns the funds.
Slippage	The gap between the price you expected and the price you got.
Spread	The distance between best buy and best sell. A cost that never appears as a fee.
Spot	Buying the asset itself, no borrowing involved.
Stablecoin	A token designed to track a currency, usually the dollar. Designed to, not guaranteed to.
TDS	Tax deducted at source. In India, 1% on virtual digital asset transfers under Section 194S.
UID	Your public account number on an exchange. Safe to share. A password is not.
Volume	How much was traded. Thin volume means worse fills.

This edition contains no referral links and no exchange sign-up offers. Nothing in this guide is financial, investment or tax advice, and none of it is a recommendation to buy, sell or hold any asset. Cryptocurrency is volatile and high risk and you can lose your entire investment. Exchange availability varies by country; confirm eligibility on the platform's own site before registering. Tax information is a summary of published rules as of September 2026 and is not a substitute for professional advice. Other pages on blocknbull.xyz do carry referral links to exchanges and are labelled where they appear. Do your own research and consult a qualified professional before making financial decisions. 18+.

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